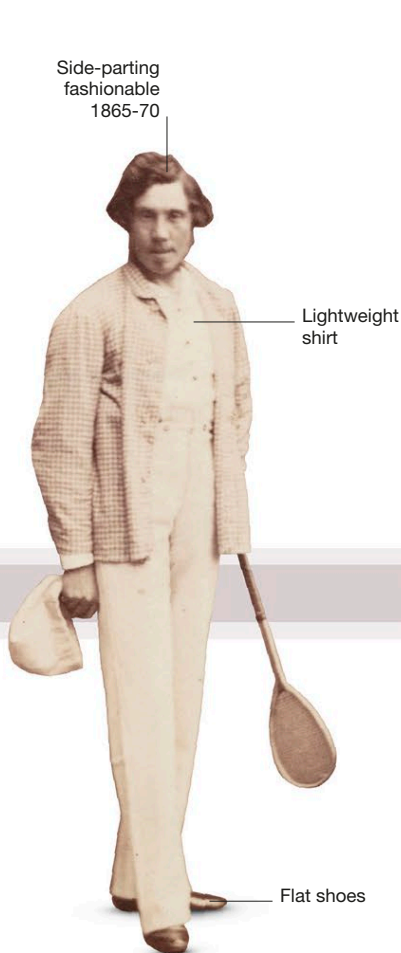


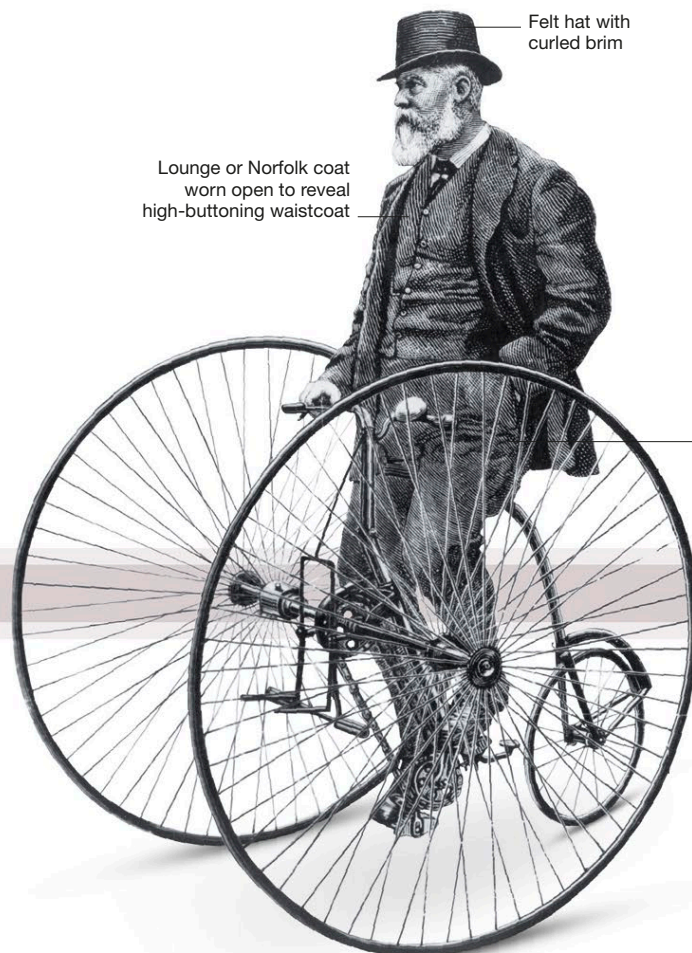
1837–1900

MEN OF ACTION

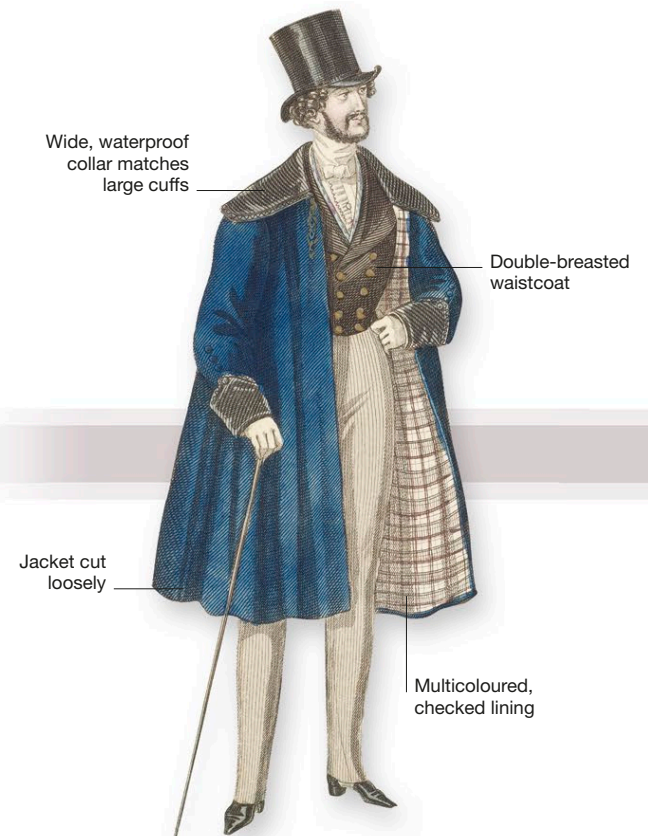
While men's suits settled into sobriety and uniformly dark colouring, their leisurewear for sports and country pursuits became more flamboyant and revealing. Garments were adapted for the purpose of health-oriented exercise, using stretchy materials such as knitted jersey. Drapers who supplied cloth and ready-to-wear shirts began to focus increasingly on sportswear for pursuits such as cricket, boating, mountaineering, and golf. Men wore plus fours for golf from the 1860s. From the mid-century French companies and Britain's Aquascutum and Burberry developed lined, twilled cotton fabrics for waterproof outerwear for the "huntin', shootin', fishin'" fraternity. Shepherd plaid, a black-and-white check, was popular in the 1890s. Sporting clubs and activities brought industrialists, military men, artists, and writers together, in pursuit of healthy bodies to fuel the mind. J.M. Barrie, author of *Peter Pan*, even had his own cricket team from 1887.



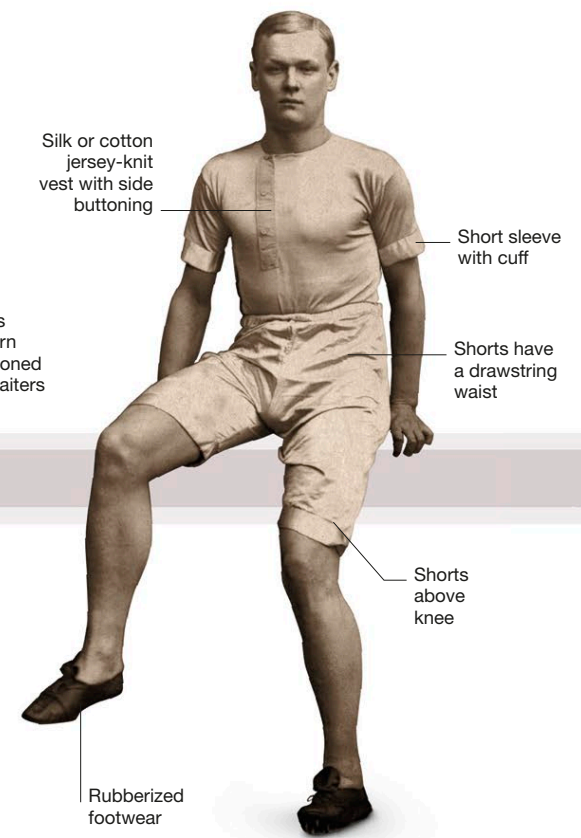
Tennis clothes "Whites" were established for tennis and cricket as early as the late 1860s. This tennis outfit consists of a lightweight linen jacket, now called a blazer, with trousers, cotton shirt, and a cap.



Cycling suit The Earl of Albermarle, president of the National Cyclists' Union, rides a tricycle, c.1880. He wears a woollen three-piece suit consisting of single-breasted jacket, waistcoat, and breeches that finish just below the knee.



Paletot jacket The paletot for men hung loosely from the shoulders and was sleeved. Checked and tartan woollen linings, as in this example of c.1838, provided warmth for country clothing. They later became a fashion statement.



Team sports Men undertook football, rugby, and rowing in variations of vest and drawers. This sportsman, c.1890, may be a member of Cambridge University's rowing team. His short-sleeved vest precedes the T-shirt.